

banking and investment systems were created, nor were there any people of colour chiming in with their experiences to create a more inclusive, holistic system that would go on to benefit everyone who used it.

Women around the world weren't able to do even the most basic financial planning for most of modern history.

During the 1700s in the US and UK, British common law allowed for husbands to have complete control of any property a woman brought into the marriage. Progress was slow: in 1771 women were allowed to have a voice on how husbands managed their joint assets. How generous. Women weren't able to open up their own businesses either. In 1787, women in Massachusetts, US, were allowed to run their own businesses, but this was more about taking over for their husbands when the men had to go to sea. It wasn't quite a feminist act. It's also important to acknowledge that in the US these laws only applied to 'women of European descent', not all women — African American women were still without basic human rights during this time and were completely kept out of the financial sphere.

It wasn't till 1900, only 120 years ago, when women in every state in the US were able to control property. In Australia and New Zealand, it was 1884. In the UK, it wasn't until 1922, and in India, 1956. That's only one to three generations ago where the women in our families could control their own property.

Only in the 1960s and 1970s were women able to open up a bank account, get their own credit card or even get a mortgage.

Before the US *Equal Credit Opportunity Act* passed in 1974, single, widowed or divorced women in the US still had to bring in a man to co-sign credit applications. Women in Ireland could only own their own homes after 1976. Single women in New Zealand were being denied mortgages even as late as 1982, some being told they needed their father to co-sign. How can we expect to know how to invest when less than 50 years ago we couldn't even open up a bank account? Even to this day, women in certain parts of the world still struggle to access their full financial rights. While there are no laws in countries like Saudi Arabia prohibiting women from buying or